

Part B: Social Media and Digital Communication

Social Media Checklist

The College Student's Guide to Responsible Social Media

Do's:

- **Do showcase your projects:** Use platforms like LinkedIn or Twitter to share your coding projects, websites, or newly learned technical skills.
- **Do curate your privacy settings:** Regularly check who can view your personal posts on platforms like Instagram and adjust settings to your comfort level.
- **Do network with professionals:** Follow industry leaders, join relevant professional groups, and engage meaningfully with their content.
- **Do think before you post:** Take a second to consider how a post might be interpreted by a future employer, professor, or peer.
- **Do keep personal details private:** Avoid sharing exact locations, your daily class schedule, or sensitive contact information publicly.

Don'ts:

- **Don't post offensive or polarizing content:** Avoid hate speech, discriminatory remarks, or highly aggressive arguments that leave a permanent negative digital footprint.
- **Don't complain about professors or peers:** Venting about your university, specific classes, or classmates online can easily get back to them and damage your academic reputation.
- **Don't engage in public flame wars:** If a disagreement arises online, take it to direct messages or disengage entirely rather than fighting in comment sections.
- **Don't post unverified information:** Avoid sharing sensationalized news or rumours without fact-checking the source first.
- **Don't forget the internet is forever:** Never assume a deleted post is truly gone; screenshots can easily resurface years later.